Architecture health check

Sample company

Prepared 24 October 2026

The short answer

Sample company, as at 24 Oct 2026. Each section below names the record behind every figure.

- 10 applications are recorded. 0 have no accountable owner.
- Business unit is the least complete field: 10 of 10 applications have none recorded.
- 10 critical systems were traced for what would stop if they failed.
- 4 groups of overlapping applications share a capability, and 0 groups were flagged as duplicates.
- 0 of 10 applications could be scored; 10 need more evidence first.
- No contracts are recorded, so renewals could not be reported.

1. Application inventory

Every application with its owner, cost, lifecycle stage and criticality, and how complete each field is.

10 applications are recorded.

FIELD	RECORDED	MISSING	COMPLETE
Owner	10 of 10	0	100%
Annual cost	10 of 10	0	100%
Lifecycle stage	10 of 10	0	100%
Business criticality	10 of 10	0	100%
Business unit	0 of 10	10	0%
Vendor	10 of 10	0	100%

APPLICATION	OWNER	ANNUAL COST	LIFECYCLE	CRITICALITY	BUSINESS UNIT
Customer web app	Alex Morgan	GBP 61,200	2.1 strategic	High	Not recorded
Data warehouse	Alex Morgan	GBP 104,400	2.1 strategic	High	Not recorded

APPLICATION	OWNER	ANNUAL COST	LIFECYCLE	CRITICALITY	BUSINESS UNIT
Document management	Alex Morgan	GBP 25,800	3. sunset	High	Not recorded
Finance system	Alex Morgan	GBP 88,800	2.2 tactical	High	Not recorded
Identity provider	Alex Morgan	GBP 22,800	2.1 strategic	High	Not recorded
Inventory system	Alex Morgan	GBP 52,800	2.2 tactical	High	Not recorded
Monitoring dashboard	Alex Morgan	GBP 13,200	2.2 tactical	High	Not recorded
Notification service	Alex Morgan	GBP 16,200	2.2 tactical	High	Not recorded
Order management system	Alex Morgan	GBP 81,600	2.2 tactical	High	Not recorded
Payments service	Alex Morgan	GBP 74,400	2.1 strategic	High	Not recorded

Recommendation: Fill business unit first; they are the fields most often missing.

2. What breaks if a critical system fails

For each application marked critical or high, the things that would stop, by layer and by how many steps away they are, with the owner of each.

Customer web app

High criticality. Owner: Alex Morgan.

1 thing depends on it: 1 in the strategy layer.

AFFECTED	LAYER	STEPS AWAY	OWNER	BASIS
Sell to customers online	Strategy	1	Alex Morgan	Stated in your data

Data warehouse

High criticality. Owner: Alex Morgan.

1 thing depends on it: 1 in the strategy layer.

AFFECTED	LAYER	STEPS AWAY	OWNER	BASIS
Manage stock	Strategy	1	Alex Morgan	Stated in your data

Document management

High criticality. Owner: Alex Morgan.

Nothing in the model depends on this application.

Finance system

High criticality. Owner: Alex Morgan.

2 things depend on it: 1 in the strategy layer, 1 in the business layer.

AFFECTED	LAYER	STEPS AWAY	OWNER	BASIS
Process online payments	Strategy	1	Alex Morgan	Stated in your data
Handle customer checkout	Business	2	No owner recorded	Stated in your data

Identity provider

High criticality. Owner: Alex Morgan.

1 thing depends on it: 1 in the strategy layer.

AFFECTED	LAYER	STEPS AWAY	OWNER	BASIS
Sell to customers online	Strategy	1	Alex Morgan	Stated in your data

Inventory system

High criticality. Owner: Alex Morgan.

6 things depend on it: 3 in the strategy layer, 2 in the application layer, 1 in the business layer.

AFFECTED	LAYER	STEPS AWAY	OWNER	BASIS
Manage stock	Strategy	1	Alex Morgan	Stated in your data
Order management system	Application	1	Alex Morgan	Stated in your data
Customer web app	Application	2	Alex Morgan	Stated in your data
Track customer orders	Strategy	2	Alex Morgan	Stated in your data
Fulfil customer order	Business	3	No owner recorded	Stated in your data
Sell to customers online	Strategy	3	Alex Morgan	Stated in your data

Monitoring dashboard

High criticality. Owner: Alex Morgan.

2 things depend on it: 1 in the strategy layer, 1 in the business layer.

AFFECTED	LAYER	STEPS AWAY	OWNER	BASIS
Track customer orders	Strategy	1	Alex Morgan	Stated in your data
Fulfil customer order	Business	2	No owner recorded	Stated in your data

Notification service

High criticality. Owner: Alex Morgan.

5 things depend on it: 2 in the application layer, 2 in the strategy layer, 1 in the business layer.

AFFECTED	LAYER	STEPS AWAY	OWNER	BASIS
Order management system	Application	1	Alex Morgan	Stated in your data
Track customer orders	Strategy	1	Alex Morgan	Stated in your data
Customer web app	Application	2	Alex Morgan	Stated in your data
Fulfil customer order	Business	2	No owner recorded	Stated in your data
Sell to customers online	Strategy	3	Alex Morgan	Stated in your data

Order management system

High criticality. Owner: Alex Morgan.

4 things depend on it: 1 in the application layer, 2 in the strategy layer, 1 in the business layer.

AFFECTED	LAYER	STEPS AWAY	OWNER	BASIS
Customer web app	Application	1	Alex Morgan	Stated in your data
Track customer orders	Strategy	1	Alex Morgan	Stated in your data
Fulfil customer order	Business	2	No owner recorded	Stated in your data
Sell to customers online	Strategy	2	Alex Morgan	Stated in your data

Payments service

High criticality. Owner: Alex Morgan.

7 things depend on it: 2 in the application layer, 3 in the strategy layer, 2 in the business layer.

AFFECTED	LAYER	STEPS AWAY	OWNER	BASIS
Customer web app	Application	1	Alex Morgan	Stated in your data
Order management system	Application	1	Alex Morgan	Stated in your data
Process online payments	Strategy	1	Alex Morgan	Stated in your data
Handle customer checkout	Business	2	No owner recorded	Stated in your data
Sell to customers online	Strategy	2	Alex Morgan	Stated in your data
Track customer orders	Strategy	2	Alex Morgan	Stated in your data
Fulfil customer order	Business	3	No owner recorded	Stated in your data

Recommendation: Confirm each affected owner can take the call when its supplier system fails.

3. Duplicate and overlapping applications

Applications that look like the same thing, and applications that serve the same capability, with the contracts behind them.

0 duplicate groups and 4 shared capabilities were found.

FOUND AS	APPLICATIONS	CONTRACTS	COMBINED ANNUAL COST	NEAREST END DATE
Shares "Track customer orders"	Monitoring dashboard, Notification service, Order management system	No contract recorded	Not recorded	Not recorded
Shares "Manage stock"	Data warehouse, Inventory system	No contract recorded	Not recorded	Not recorded
Shares "Process online payments"	Finance system, Payments service	No contract recorded	Not recorded	Not recorded
Shares "Sell to customers online"	Customer web app, Identity provider	No contract recorded	Not recorded	Not recorded

Recommendation: Review each overlapping group with its contracts and decide which application stays.

4. Applications with no recorded owner

The applications nobody is accountable for, most critical first, and how well each business unit is covered.

0 of 10 applications have no recorded owner.

BUSINESS UNIT	WITH AN OWNER	COVERAGE
No business unit recorded	10 of 10	100%

Recommendation: Every application has an accountable owner.

5. What to do with each application

A recommendation (Tolerate, Invest, Migrate or Eliminate) and a health score from 0 to 100 for each application with enough recorded evidence.

0 of 10 applications have enough evidence to score.

Not yet scored

These need the facts listed before a recommendation can be relied on. The indicative figures are what the scoring gives today, and they are not a recommendation.

APPLICATION	FACTS STILL NEEDED	INDICATIVE RECOMMENDATION	INDICATIVE SCORE
Customer web app	Lifecycle Status, Risk Assessment	Invest	59 of 100
Data warehouse	Lifecycle Status, Risk Assessment	Invest	54 of 100
Document management	Lifecycle Status, Risk Assessment	Invest	68 of 100
Finance system	Lifecycle Status, Risk Assessment	Invest	59 of 100
Identity provider	Lifecycle Status, Risk Assessment	Invest	61 of 100
Inventory system	Lifecycle Status, Risk Assessment	Invest	59 of 100
Monitoring dashboard	Lifecycle Status, Risk Assessment	Invest	61 of 100
Notification service	Lifecycle Status, Risk Assessment	Invest	61 of 100
Order management system	Lifecycle Status, Risk Assessment	Invest	59 of 100

APPLICATION	FACTS STILL NEEDED	INDICATIVE RECOMMENDATION	INDICATIVE SCORE
Payments service	Lifecycle Status, Risk Assessment	Invest	59 of 100

Recommendation: Record the missing facts for the 10 applications not scored, then re-run the scoring.

6. Renewals in the next quarter

Active contracts that renew by 22 Jan 2027, including any already past their renewal date, with what each costs a year and whether it renews by itself.

No contracts are recorded.

Recommendation: Share your contract list (vendor, annual cost, renewal date, auto-renewal) to produce this section.